

Chairman Notes - July 13-19, 2026

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Life and Ministry Meeting | Jeremiah 16-17

Opening Comments (~1 min)

Brothers and sisters, this week's meeting has a very clear thread: *It matters whom we trust*. Jeremiah 17 contrasts two lives. The person who trusts in humans becomes like a lonely shrub in dry country, but the one who trusts in Jehovah is like a tree planted near waters, still fruitful even when heat comes.

Tonight we will see that trust from several angles: in our Bible reading, in our ministry, and especially in the part for young ones on trusting God's Word for practical advice. So as the meeting progresses, maybe keep this question in mind: *When pressure comes, where do I instinctively look first for guidance?* Let us be helped tonight to make Jehovah and his Word our first place of trust.

Student Commendation Scratch Pad

Use this section during the student assignments. The first line reminds you of the lesson point; the blank lines are for what you personally observed and can commend.

3. Bible Reading - Jeremiah 17:5-18

Student: _____

Lesson: th Study 5 - Accurate Reading

Focus: Read aloud exactly what is on the page. Prepare well, pronounce words correctly, speak clearly, and observe punctuation.

Look for: accurate words, clear pronunciation, natural word groups, good use of punctuation, not rushed.

Possible commendation:

"Thank you. What I appreciated was how carefully you handled the reading. You read in clear thought groups, and that helped the contrast in Jeremiah 17 come through naturally."

My notes / commendation:

4. Starting a Conversation - House to House

Students: Caitlin Conaghan / Lily McGreevy

Lesson: 1md Lesson 5, Point 5 - Tact

Focus: Agree with and commend the person where possible. Build common ground first, then progressively help the person understand what the Bible teaches.

Assignment detail: Feature a video from the Teaching Toolbox.

Look for: warm tone, respectful wording, no arguing, common ground, smooth introduction of the video.

Possible commendation:

"I liked the tact you showed. Before introducing the video, you found common ground and kept the conversation gracious. That made the video feel helpful, not forced."

My notes / commendation:

5. Following Up - House to House

Students: Anne Coldicott / Anna Morena Amorante

Lesson: 1md Lesson 7, Point 4 - Perseverance

Focus: Make an appointment. At the end of each conversation, try to confirm a specific time when you can speak with the person again, and keep the appointment.

Assignment detail: Offer a Bible study.

Look for: hopeful tone, clear offer of a Bible study, specific next arrangement, fitting the householder's schedule.

Possible commendation:

"You did well to move the call forward. Rather than leaving it vague, you offered the Bible study clearly and arranged a definite time to continue."

My notes / commendation:

6. Making Disciples - Enjoy Life Forever Lesson 19

Student: Carolyn Adams

Lesson: 1md Lesson 11, Point 3 - Simplicity

Focus: Do not talk too much. Focus on the study publication, ask a question, wait patiently for the student to answer, and use additional questions to help him reason.

Assignment detail: 1ff Lesson 19 summary, review, and goal.

Look for: short explanations, use of the lesson material, patient pauses, questions that help the student answer, not overloading the point.

Possible commendation:

“That was nicely simple. You let the student do the thinking, waited for the answer, and kept the discussion focused on the main point of the lesson.”

My notes / commendation:

Closing Comments (~1 min)

Tonight we were reminded that trust is not just a feeling. It shows in whose counsel we follow, how we respond to direction, how we handle people in the ministry, and how our young ones face pressure at school.

Jeremiah 17 gave us that strong picture of the tree planted near water. The heat still comes, but the tree does not stop producing fruit. That is what Jehovah can help us become if we keep trusting him, his Word, and the loving direction he provides. So this week, when we need advice or reassurance, let us go first to Jehovah. Read, pray, research, and let his thinking guide ours.

Announcements

1. New Congregation Bible Study Publication

Next week at the Congregation Bible Study, we will begin our new publication, *Walk Courageously With God*. This study will strengthen our courage to face trials now and in the future, including during the great tribulation.

We encourage everyone to prepare for this study each week. Read the narrative, look up the Bible passages on which the chapter is based, and use the references to find answers to the questions in the “Dig Deeper” section.

As you prepare, reflect on the practical lessons you learn from the account. Then meditate on what the material teaches you about Jehovah and how it relates to his purpose.

Although the “Learn More” section will not be considered during the study, reviewing the references in this section as part of your personal study or family worship can help deepen your appreciation for the Bible character and the courage he or she displayed.

2. Service Committee Changes

The body of elders has agreed to make some changes in our service committee, effective immediately.

Brother Jack Toia will be serving as our service overseer, and Brother Richard McKernan will be serving as our secretary.

We also want to thank Daveson and Kevin for the hard work they have done in their respective roles, and we wish Jack and Richard Jehovah’s rich blessing as they take on their new assignments.

3. Kingdom Hall Dedication Anniversary

Today, July 15, marks 51 years since this Kingdom Hall was dedicated by the branch overseer, Brother Clyde Canty.